

JAHIRA STERLING

Franklin Park NJ, 08823 | (732) 320-2611 | jsterling1128@gmail.com

Senior Policy Analyst & Public Affairs Expert

Dynamic and insightful professional with a robust background in policy analysis, public affairs, and higher education. Proven ability to manage and execute large-scale projects, with significant experience in health equity, complex care initiatives, and educational program development. Proficient in engineering and leading initiatives, such as external-facing webinars, multi-state convenings, and strategic partnerships that advance health equity, educational access, and public service. Skilled in crafting policy implementations, providing emotional and practical support to diverse populations, and enhancing organizational processes through inclusive leadership and strategic oversight. Adept at fostering cross-sector collaborations, enhancing community engagement through strategic communications, and facilitating workshops to promote policy understanding and implementation. Eager to leverage experience and a passion for advocacy to drive impactful outcomes in policy analysis and student affairs in a progressive organization.

CORE SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

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| • Strategic Policy Analysis | • Project Management | • Educational Programming |
| • Legislative Advocacy | • Public Speaking | • Health Policy |
| • Stakeholder Engagement | • Research & Analysis | • Financial Stewardship |
| • Program Development | • Regulatory Compliance | • Data-Driven Decision Making |
| • Diversity & Inclusion Initiatives | • Community Outreach | • Change Management |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CENTER FOR HEALTH CARE STRATEGIES

(2022 – Present)

Program Associate

Engineer and lead numerous external-facing webinars, presenting project insights and updates across multiple health-focused initiatives. Contribute to subsequent promotions within the organization by mentoring new program associates and providing training and resources. Author and disseminate a wide array of written content including briefs, case studies, blog posts, and fact sheets, focusing on Medicaid innovation, health equity, and complex care topics such as 1115 waiver implementations and cross-sector strategies for homelessness.

- *Orchestrated project management and technical support for key initiatives such as Population Health, Health Equity, and Complex Care, notably in the Partnerships for Action project targeting homelessness and the ASTHO 2103 initiative, fostering health equity through strategic public and Medicaid partnerships.*
- *Shaped policy implementations within health entities and public institutions at various governmental levels by analyzing extensive literature and evaluating health equity interventions across the U.S.*
- *Offered expert insights and operational strategies to state grantees within a virtual learning environment by directing a targeted workshop on Medicaid financing.*
- *Achieved high attendee satisfaction for events with over 60 participants by arranging multi-state in-person convenings and managing event logistics in major cities including Los Angeles, Oakland, Detroit, Baltimore, and Charlotte.*
- *Enhanced organizational culture by promoting inclusivity, improving employee engagement, and facilitating open dialogues on diversity by leading the establishment of a racial awareness affinity group, orchestrating over 30 virtual sessions.*

RUTGERS UNIVERSITY, OFFICE OF NEW STUDENT AND FAMILY PROGRAMS (NSFP)

(2021 – 2022)

Graduate Coordinator

Supported the Program Coordinator and Director in executing major initiatives such as the New Student Orientation (SOAR) and Raider Representation Program. Mentored students extensively, focusing on leadership development and confidence building to prepare them for post-graduation success.

- *Provided strategic guidance and resources to its executive board by co-advising the Transfer Student Organization (TSO).*
- *Enhanced mentorship between upperclassmen and new students at RU-N by steering the Peer Connection program.*
- *Fostered engagement and mentorship opportunities for family members of students by co-developing and launching the Family Advisory Council at RU-N.*
- *Received awards from faculty for exceptional performance, resilience, and dedication to student support and comfort.*

NEW JERSEY LEGISLATIVE BLACK CAUCUS FOUNDATION (NJLBCF); DISTRICT 22

(2021)

Congressional Summer Intern

Collaborated with Plainfield City Clerk AJ Jalloh, contributing to municipal operations and community engagement strategies. Developed political leadership and policy analysis skills through hands-on experience and targeted workshops led by former NJLBCF members and New Jersey assembly members.

- *Represented District 22 in Plainfield, New Jersey while engaging directly with NJLBCF members and local constituents to address community concerns and initiatives.*
- *Enhanced service delivery and constituent relations by assisting Congresswoman Linda Carter and team in executing special projects and legislative tasks.*
- *Acquired in-depth knowledge of policy-making and government operations, positioning for a future career in public service.*

VERUS LLC

(2020 – 2021)

Temporary Social Worker/Caseworker

Represented Krause and Kinsman Law Firm in Minnesota, actively supporting the Boy Scouts of America sexual abuse litigation, focusing on survivor advocacy and legal claim processing. Delivered essential support services to claimants in United States by collaborating with a national network of attorneys. Organized detailed interviews with sexual abuse survivors to assist in completing proof of claims and providing critical emotional support.

- *Earned commendations from claimants by recognizing for exceptional social work skills and empathetic client interactions.*
- *Contributed to a team of social workers that successfully submitted over 6K claims while demonstrating strong teamwork and commitment to client advocacy.*
- *Obtained a two-month contract extension for outstanding contributions to the project, including the application of emotional intelligence and exceptional support in complex casework.*

NEWARK BOARD OF EDUCATION SPECIAL SERVICES UNIT

(2019 – 2020)

Social Work Intern

Conducted regular visits to Newark Public Schools to monitor student progress and collaborate with school social workers to improve service coordination. Cultivated deep expertise in social work practices, with a focus on serving homeless populations, and developing crucial skills and ethical competencies.

- *Delivered comprehensive support to displaced families by providing essential resources such as bus cards, backpacks, hygiene kits, transportation, educational materials, free uniforms, lunches, and access to community services.*
- *Advocated tirelessly for the educational rights of displaced students within the Newark school system, ensuring their stability and continuity of education.*
- *Leveraged the McKinney Vento Homeless Act to support and empower parents and students, facilitating access to necessary educational and social services.*

RUTGERS UNIVERSITY-NEWARK

(2019)

Summer Housing Assistant

Excelled in a leadership role within a collaborative team environment while enhancing operational efficiency in summer housing. Partnered with Area Directors on various housing projects, contributing to the management and execution of residential services.

- *Provided exceptional customer service, addressing the diverse needs and concerns of summer housing residents.*
- *Honored with the Outstanding Service Award for exemplary performance to the Rutgers Newark Housing community.*

SOMERSET ARC

(2016 – 2018)

Caretaker

Developed a deep understanding of the needs and challenges faced by children and youth with disabilities to enhance personal and professional caregiving skills. Supported educational development by assisting with homework, and managing meal and snack distribution to children.

- *Achieved measurable improvements in speech, eye contact, and social interactions by providing specialized care to a client on the autism spectrum.*
- *Enhanced client's skills through engaging activities, such as neighborhood walks, puzzle-solving, and utilizing the Dynavox program to aid speech development.*

EDUCATION

Master of Public Administration, Concentration in Healthcare Administration, RUTGERS UNIVERSITY-NEWARK, 2022

Bachelor of Social Work, Minor in Anthropology, RUTGERS UNIVERSITY-NEWARK, 2020